Strategic report

Chief Executive's review

The group delivered a resilient performance in a challenging market, supported by a strong balance sheet and disciplined capital allocation. The board remains focused on cash generation, customer service and long-term value creation for all stakeholders. The group delivered a resilient performance in a challenging market, supported by a strong balance sheet and disciplined capital allocation. The board remains focused on cash generation, customer service and long-term value creation for all stakeholders. The group delivered a resilient performance in a challenging market, supported by a strong balance sheet and disciplined capital allocation. The board remains focused on cash generation, customer service and long-term value creation for all stakeholders.

Governance

Directors' report

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Consolidated financial statements

Consolidated income statement

For the year ended 31 December 2025

	Notes	2025 £m	2024 £m
Sales of goods	3	12,345	11,890
Cost of sales		(8,645)	(8,390)
Gross profit		3,700	3,500
Administrative expenses	4	(2,220)	(2,150)
Operating profit	4	1,480	1,350
Finance income	6	30	20
Finance costs	6	(410)	(380)
Profit before taxation		1,110	990
Taxation	7	(275)	(248)
Profit for the year		**825**	**742**

Consolidated financial statements

Consolidated balance sheet

As at 31 December 2025

	Notes	2025 £m	2024 £m
Non-current assets			
Property, plant and equipment	10	4,100	4,000
Right-of-use assets	11	2,300	2,250
Intangible assets	12	600	620
		7,000	6,870
Current assets			
Inventories	14	1,300	1,250
Trade and other receivables	15	900	860
Cash and cash equivalents	16	750	640
		2,950	2,750
Current liabilities			
Trade and other payables	17	(2,600)	(2,480)
Borrowings	18	(400)	(350)
Lease liabilities	19	(300)	(290)
		(3,300)	(3,120)
Non-current liabilities			
Borrowings	18	(4,200)	(4,300)
Lease liabilities	19	(2,150)	(2,120)
Provisions	20	(650)	(600)
		(7,000)	(7,020)
Net liabilities		**(350)**	**(520)**
Equity			
Share capital	21	500	500
Retained deficit		(1,050)	(1,210)
Non-controlling interests		200	190
Total equity		**(350)**	**(520)**

Notes to the consolidated financial statements

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